

NAVEEN REDDY ALKA

San Francisco Bay Area | 314-498-5314 | naveenreddy.alka@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/naveenreddyalka

PROFILE

Senior Software Engineer with 17+ years and deep Apache Kafka expertise — used Kafka as the backbone of event-driven architectures at MakeMyTrip (payment streaming), Pearson (org-wide event pipelines), Wenova (real-time customer data propagation), and VERSE. Specializes in distributed systems, messaging infrastructure, and large-scale backend engineering. Java/Scala/Kafka/Cassandra/Kubernetes. MS CS, ASU 2021.

SKILLS

Languages: Java (SCJP 98%), Scala, Kotlin, TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, Perl

Frameworks: Spring Boot, Spring WebFlux, Project Reactor, Hibernate, Finagle, Node.js, GraphQL, Jersey

Messaging: Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, ActiveMQ

Databases: Cassandra, Redis, CouchBase, Elasticsearch, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Oracle, MongoDB

Cloud & Infra: AWS, GCP, Azure, Kubernetes, Docker, Nginx, HAProxy, Tomcat

Observability: Datadog, New Relic, Splunk, Sentry, Graphite/StatsD

CI/CD: GitLab CI/CD, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Maven, Gradle, Git

Practices: Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, Event Sourcing, TDD, PCI DSS, Agile/Scrum

EXPERIENCE

Credit Karma, Oakland · Staff Software Engineer · Feb 2022 – Present

- Designed and built the Portal Provider framework — core abstraction for dynamic portal configuration powering **90%+ of Credit Karma portals clients**; foundation of the federated portals SDK adopted org-wide.
- Led end-to-end delivery of Dashboard × Portals SDK federation — designed Bridge API for phased A/B rollout, achieved **100% production ramp**, enabled RecSys V2 integration, unblocked HELOC/Home Refi verticals; recognized with 5+ public kudos by VP and two Directors.
- Architected Portals Local Eligibility (GA Feb 2025) — moved eligibility into client-side SDK delivering **45% faster rendering** and eliminating redundant upstream network calls.
- Led Data Contracts from inception through production (Oct 2025) — cross-language codegen (TypeScript, GraphQL, Scala), Thrift IDL, automated publish pipeline reducing release time **from days to minutes**; named org-wide adoption lead by Director.
- Resolved critical Talon/Polly production incidents: memory leaks, pm2 socket exhaustion, MGS startup latency spikes; built reusable load testing infrastructure now used across all Polly teams.
- Own and evolve Finagle-based web framework (EOL Twitter stack) serving all Credit Karma product teams — SLAs, scalability, incremental modernization in Scala and TypeScript.

Turo, San Francisco · Senior Software Engineer · Jan 2021 – Feb 2022

- Resolved critical network, infra, and design-level bottlenecks — optimized API-to-database patterns reducing latency by up to **30%** and improving overall throughput.
- Led modernization of high-traffic legacy services, improving reliability and reducing incident rate across the backend.

Pearson Inc, San Francisco · Senior Software Engineer · Jan 2020 – Jan 2021

- Architected cross-cutting platform services (logging, security, metrics, monitoring) using Spring WebFlux + Project Reactor — adopted by **all engineering teams**, standardizing observability org-wide.
- Delivered Kafka event pipelines, CouchBase data layer, and Kubernetes + AWS shared infra enabling Pearson's reactive architecture roadmap.

Nordstrom, Seattle · Senior Engineer · Mar 2019 – Oct 2019

- Ordering and Allocation team — led decommission of legacy monolithic ordering systems into Kubernetes-native microservices using Spring Boot + REST/SOAP across AWS and GCP.
- Drove performance optimization and security hardening; worked with MySQL/Postgres, Docker/Linux, Git.

Wenova Inc, St. Louis · Software Engineer · Mar 2018 – Mar 2019

- Designed and built Customer Data Hub (CDH) — central microservice exposing REST + GraphQL APIs to 10+ internal systems including Salesforce, with Kafka event-driven propagation.
- Delivered Java/Spring/Hibernate services on AWS with PostgreSQL/NoSQL; XML/XSLT/SOAP data transformation pipelines.

MakeMyTrip, Bangalore · Sr. Principal Software Engineer — Payments Architect · Sep 2016 – Jan 2018

- Sole architect of MakeMyTrip's payments platform revamp — multi-datacenter, multi-tenant system integrating **80+ payment gateways and aggregators** (saved cards over HSM, wallets, discounting, fraud management).
- Achieved **50% reduction in payment response time**, **60% reduction in maintenance cost**, and **2%+ improvement in payment success rate** over billions of dollars of monthly transactions — driving **millions in incremental revenue**.
- Built and led team of 5 engineers; owned full delivery: architecture reviews with CTO, A/B testing, staged rollout, disaster recovery, full CI/CD via Jenkins + Cucumber + Selenium.
- Stack: Java · Spring · Hibernate · MySQL · CouchBase · RabbitMQ · Kafka · Cassandra · Tomcat.

VERSE – DailyHunt, Bangalore · Principal Software Engineer · Apr 2016 – Sep 2016

- Designed Books search platform — full-text search, fuzzy matching, autocomplete, vernacular support serving millions of queries via Elasticsearch + Node.js.
- Stack: Java · Spring · Hibernate · Elasticsearch · Node.js · Kafka · Redis · Docker.

Myntra – Flipkart, Bangalore · Technical Lead, Secure Checkout · Dec 2013 – Mar 2016

- Led Secure Checkout team owning Payments, Address, and Cart — **100% uptime at 500M+ active carts and 150,000+ daily payment transactions** on India's largest fashion platform.
- Built Payment Plan Service (PPS) from scratch — unified all payment instruments (CC, DC, Gift Cards, Wallets, CashBack) with dynamic gateway auto-switching algorithm.
- Engineered 50x traffic scaling for End of Season Sale — Cassandra NoSQL primary store + first-of-its-kind application-level distributed sharding over MySQL for 500M+ objects.
- Stack: Java · Spring · Hibernate · MySQL · Cassandra · Jersey · Nginx · ZooKeeper · ActiveMQ · Elasticsearch · HAProxy.

Wavecrest Payment Services · Dev Lead · Nov 2009 – Dec 2013

- Founding member of Wavecrest engineering team — promoted **3 times in 4 years** (SE → SSE → Lead Engineer → Dev Lead).
- Led 8-engineer team building cashier and eWallet products — prepaid cards, payroll cards, digital wallets, mobile payments processing **200,000+ card issuances per day** with PCI compliance.
- Delivered financial systems for PartyGaming-Bwin, Reliance, GTECH, TrillionPay, O2; accountable for architecture, code quality, mentorship.
- Stack: Java · Spring · Hibernate · MySQL · ActiveMQ · SOAP · REST · Redis · Docker · Jenkins.

IvyComptech, Hyderabad · Software Engineer · Jan 2009 – Nov 2009

- Built scalable components for Store, Affiliates, and Loyalty Systems on a high-traffic gaming affiliate platform.
- Stack: Java · Spring · Struts2 · Perl · MySQL · Ajax · Jenkins · Tomcat.

Cognizant, Hyderabad · Program Analyst · Nov 2007 – Jan 2009

- Core engineer on American Express small business apply site — led Apply-Strategy project: complete data management system upgrade, data migration, DOJO migration from MooTools.
- Stack: Java · J2EE · Struts · XSLT · XSD · Dojo · EJB · RMI · Tomcat.

EDUCATION

Arizona State University — MS Computer Science, 2021

National Institute of Technology, Warangal — B.Tech Civil Engineering, 2007